

Competitive Battle Cards.

Datadog · PagerDuty · Groundcover

Partner Resource

For authorised partners only

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Three reference cards for the most common displacement conversations: **Datadog**, **PagerDuty**, and **Groundcover**. Each card follows the same pattern — positioning, landmines (what the incumbent will say), and your counter.

Datadog

WHERE THEY WIN

Breadth. Datadog sells one platform that touches APM, infra metrics, logs, real-user monitoring, security, and more. Dashboards are polished and integrations are plentiful.

WHERE THEY LOSE

Cost and lock-in. A mid-sized SaaS routinely spends \$250K-1M+/yr on Datadog. Their pricing is per-host, per-GB, per-span, per-user — impossible to forecast. Custom metrics cost extra. Log rehydration costs extra. Everything costs extra.

LANDMINES THEY'LL DROP

- "We have more integrations." → Yes, but you only use 15 of them.
- "Our APM is more mature." → True for deep profiling; we're competitive for standard tracing.
- "We're SOC 2 / HIPAA / FedRAMP." → So are we (minus FedRAMP, which is on the roadmap).

YOUR COUNTER

- **Run the TCO calculator.** A 50-engineer SaaS saves 45-60% on year-one spend with SREonCall.
 - **Show the unified incident → metrics → logs → trace flow.** Datadog's incident product is an afterthought bolted on after the PagerDuty acquisition failed.
 - **Offer the data export guarantee.** SREonCall commits to 30-day data export at any time, no fee.
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PagerDuty

WHERE THEY WIN

Brand. PagerDuty is the default answer for "what do we use for on-call?" — especially in enterprise procurement. Deep ServiceNow, Jira, Slack integrations.

WHERE THEY LOSE

Everything except on-call. PagerDuty has no observability. Their incident analytics are thin. Their AIOps is a reskinned anomaly detector. They'll sell you Rundeck for automation for another \$50K.

LANDMINES THEY'LL DROP

- "We're the incident management standard." → For scheduling, yes. For actual resolution, no.
- "Our Event Intelligence correlates signals." → It correlates alerts it already sees. It can't correlate alerts with logs and traces.
- "We have a marketplace." → So do we. Ours is free.

YOUR COUNTER

- **Bring observability into the incident.** When the page fires, the incident view already shows the spike, the log anomaly, and the affected trace.
 - **Show the runbook + AI agent flow.** Our agents can actually execute the runbook, not just link to it.
 - **Unified billing.** One contract, not three (PD + Datadog + Rundeck).
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Groundcover

WHERE THEY WIN

eBPF-based ingestion is genuinely clever. Low-overhead, infra-side instrumentation with no SDK changes. Appeals to teams tired of tagging every service.

WHERE THEY LOSE

Observability-only. Groundcover is a Datadog alternative, not an SRE platform. No on-call, no incident management, no runbooks, no status pages. Their query experience is catching up to Grafana but isn't there.

LANDMINES THEY'LL DROP

- "eBPF means zero-instrumentation." → True for language-agnostic telemetry; false for business metrics.
- "We keep data in your cloud." → So can we (self-hosted mode).
- "Cost predictability." → Fair point. Match it with our flat-tier pricing.

YOUR COUNTER

- **Scope expansion.** You came for observability, you stay for the incident platform. Groundcover can't do that.
 - **Multi-tenant MSP model.** Groundcover has no answer for partners running 50 customers on one instance.
 - **AI agents in-product.** Their roadmap; our reality.
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Universal plays

Regardless of competitor, these always work:

1. **Run the 14-day PoC on a real service.** We provide a success engineer.
2. **Consolidate the bill.** Sales ops and procurement love a single vendor.
3. **Offer the MSP overlay.** Even non-MSP customers love knowing they can white-label later.
4. **Reference Alyssum Group and Binoloop.** Public case studies, happy to take calls.

Questions? partners@sreoncall.com